BBA — SEMESTER III

Office Automation & Secretarial Practices

Correspondence, Communication & Office Systems — Definitions, Formats and Real-World Practice

Unit Topics: Secretarial Qualities & Duties • Business Correspondence • Reception & Telephone Practice • Mail Handling • Office Communication Systems

What We'll Cover

Nine building blocks of modern secretarial practice

Qualities & Duties of a Secretary

Skills, ethics and core responsibilities

Drafting Business Letters

Purpose, structure and formal formats

Notices & Agenda

Announcing and structuring meetings

Office Memoranda & Circulars

Internal instructions and mass communication

Email Communication

Etiquette and professional structure

Reception of Visitors

Handling guests with professionalism

Telephone Etiquette

Voice-based professional communication

Appointment Scheduling

Managing time and diaries

Mail Handling & Office Systems

Inward/outward dak and communication tools

Who Is a Secretary?

Definition

A Secretary is an office professional entrusted with correspondence, record-keeping, appointments and confidential support so that an executive or organisation can function smoothly and efficiently.

Real-World Examples

Executive Assistant to a CEO • Company Secretary (ROC/legal compliance) • Personal Secretary • Front-Office/Administrative Secretary in colleges, hospitals & government offices

Two Broad Roles



Private Secretary

Assists one executive personally — diary, correspondence, confidential files.



Office/Administrative Secretary

Supports an entire department — records, visitor & mail handling.

Qualities of a Secretary

The personal and professional traits that build employer trust



Confidentiality & Integrity

Safeguards sensitive files, salary data and executive decisions.



Communication Skills

Clear written & spoken English/Hindi for letters, calls and meetings.



Time Management

Prioritises tasks and meets deadlines under pressure.



Organisational Ability

Systematic filing, indexing and record maintenance.



Interpersonal Skills

Courteous, tactful handling of visitors, staff and callers.



IT & Office-Automation Proficiency

Skilled in MS Office, email, DTP and office software.

Duties & Responsibilities

Six functional areas of day-to-day secretarial work

Correspondence

Drafting, typing & dispatching letters, memos and circulars.

Diary & Appointments

Scheduling meetings and managing the executive's calendar.

Records Management

Filing, indexing and retrieving documents on demand.

Meetings & Minutes

Preparing agenda, taking minutes, arranging venues.

Reception Duties

Handling calls, visitors and enquiries at the front office.

Confidential Support

Managing sensitive data, contracts and personal files.

Drafting of Business Letters

Definition

A business letter is a formal, written form of communication exchanged between organisations, or between an organisation and individuals, to conduct official business.

Functions of a Business Letter

- Creates a permanent, legally admissible record of communication.
- Builds and maintains goodwill & professional relationships.
- Conveys requests, orders, complaints, and replies formally.
- Acts as evidence in disputes, audits, or legal proceedings.

Common Types

- Enquiry & Reply Letters
- Order & Complaint Letters
- Sales & Promotional Letters
- Appointment / Offer Letters
- Recommendation Letters
- Resignation & Cover Letters

Business Letter — Standard Format

SUNRISE TEXTILES PVT. LTD.
42, Industrial Area, Kanpur – 208012 | info@sunrisetextiles.in

Ref: ST/PUR/2026-114 Date: 06 September 2026

The Manager
Rohan Paper Suppliers
Sector 12, Noida – 201301

Subject: Order for Office Stationery — Reminder

Dear Sir/Madam,

With reference to our Purchase Order No. 114 dated 20 August 2026, the consignment of A4 paper and printing supplies is still awaited. Kindly arrange dispatch within three working days and confirm the revised delivery schedule at the earliest.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully,

(Anita Sharma)
Secretary to Managing Director

Essential Parts

1. Letterhead / Sender's Address
2. Reference No. & Date
3. Inside (Receiver's) Address
4. Subject Line
5. Salutation
6. Body (Intro–Detail–Action)
7. Complimentary Close
8. Signature, Name & Designation

Notices

Definition

A notice is a formal written announcement issued to inform a specific group of people about an event, meeting or decision.

Key Elements

- Word 'NOTICE' as heading
- Name of organisation & date
- Subject of the notice
- Body — what, when, where, who
- Signature & designation of issuer

BRIGHT FUTURE COLLEGE OF COMMERCE

NOTICE

Date: 06.09.2026

Subject: Guest Lecture on Office Automation Tools

All BBA Second Year students are informed that a guest lecture on “Modern Office Automation Tools” will be held on 12 September 2026 at 11:00 A.M. in Seminar Hall 2. Attendance is compulsory for all students.

(Dr. R. Mehta)
Coordinator, BBA Programme

Agenda

Definition

An agenda is a list of items or topics to be discussed and decided upon in a meeting, circulated in advance to all participants.

Secretary's Role

- Collects items from members in advance
- Sequences items logically by priority
- Circulates agenda with notice of meeting
- Prepares minutes based on agenda items

BRIGHT FUTURE COLLEGE — BBA COMMITTEE

AGENDA

Meeting of the Cultural Committee

Date: 10 Sept 2026 Time: 3:00 P.M. Venue: Committee Room

1. Reading & confirmation of previous minutes
2. Budget approval for Annual Fest
3. Selection of event coordinators
4. Sponsorship & venue booking update
5. Any other matter with permission of the Chair

Office Memoranda (Memo)

Definition

A memorandum (memo) is a brief written message used for internal communication within the same organisation — shorter and less formal than a letter.

Used For

- Policy changes & instructions
- Inter-departmental requests
- Reminders & clarifications
- Reporting facts or decisions

MEMORANDUM

To: All Department Heads

From: Office of the Administrative Secretary

Date: 06 September 2026

Subject: Submission of Monthly Attendance Report

All department heads are requested to submit the monthly attendance report of their staff to the Administrative Office on or before the 5th of every month, to enable timely payroll processing.

(Secretary)

Circulars

Definition

A circular is a written communication sent simultaneously to a large number of people — the same message distributed to many recipients at once.

Typical Uses

- Announcing holidays or office timings
- Informing new rules/policies to all staff
- Price-list or scheme updates to dealers
- Festival greetings & general notices

CIRCULAR

Circular No. HR/07/2026 Date: 06 September 2026

To: All Employees, All Branches

Subject: Revised Office Timings

This is to inform all employees that, with effect from 15 September 2026, office hours will change to 9:30 A.M. – 6:00 P.M. (Monday–Saturday). Cooperation of all staff is requested.

(HR Manager)
for Circulation to All Departments

Email Communication

Definition

Email is the electronic exchange of official messages, replacing physical letters for fast, documented, day-to-day business communication.

Email Etiquette

- Use a clear, specific subject line
- Professional greeting & sign-off
- Concise paragraphs; one topic per mail
- Proofread before hitting 'Send'
- Use CC/BCC and 'Reply All' judiciously

New Message

To:	purchase@rohanpapers.com
Cc:	accounts@sunrisetextiles.in
Subject:	Delay in Delivery — PO#114

Dear Mr. Rohan,

As discussed telephonically, the stationery consignment against PO#114 has not yet arrived. Please confirm the dispatch date at the earliest so we may plan accordingly.

Regards,
Anita Sharma
Secretary to MD, Sunrise Textiles Pvt. Ltd.

Reception & Handling of Visitors

The reception desk is the organisation's first point of contact — the secretary must greet, verify and route every visitor with courtesy and professionalism.

1

Greet & Welcome

Stand, smile, greet warmly and offer a seat.

2

Verify Purpose

Ask name, organisation and reason for visit / appointment.

3

Visitor Register

Record entry details and issue a visitor pass/badge.

4

Inform Concerned Officer

Intercom/call the executive to confirm availability.

5

Manage Waiting

Offer refreshments; keep visitor comfortable if delayed.

6

Escort & Follow-up

Guide visitor in, and record exit time / gate pass.

Telephone Etiquette

Professional voice communication — often the caller's first impression of the organisation

Do's

- Answer within 2–3 rings
- Greet & identify: “Good morning, MD's office, Anita speaking”
- Speak clearly at a moderate pace
- Take accurate messages (name, number, purpose)
- Confirm and close politely

Don'ts

- Don't say a blunt 'Hello' without identifying
- Don't leave caller on hold without updates
- Don't eat, chew gum, or multi-task loudly
- Don't give confidential information over phone
- Don't argue — transfer politely if needed

Sample Call Script

Secretary: “Good afternoon, Sunrise Textiles, Anita speaking. How may I help you?”

Caller: “I'd like to speak with the Managing Director regarding the pending order.”

Secretary: “Certainly, may I know your name and company, please? ... Please hold while I connect you.”

Appointment Scheduling

Definition

Appointment scheduling is planning and confirming meeting times between an executive and visitors/colleagues to avoid clashes and wasted time.

Process

- Receive request (call/email/in-person)
- Check executive's diary for a free slot
- Confirm date, time & venue to the requester
- Enter into calendar & send reminder

Digital Tools Used Today



Google Calendar / Outlook Calendar

Shared diaries with instant meeting invites.



MS Teams / Zoom Scheduler

Direct booking links for virtual meetings.



Automated Reminders

SMS/Email alerts before the appointment.

Sample Diary Entry: 10 Sept, 11:00–11:30 A.M. — Mr. Rohan (Rohan Papers) — Re: Order Delay — Cabin 2

Mail Handling — Inward Correspondence

Dak received by the organisation from outside

1

Receiving

Collect mail from post/courier/email at a fixed time daily.

2

Sorting

Separate by urgency: confidential, registered, ordinary.

3

Opening & Stamping

Open (except 'confidential'), affix received date-stamp.

4

Recording

Enter serial no., sender, subject in Inward Mail Register.

5

Distribution

Route to the concerned department/executive for action.

Inward Mail Register — Sample Format

S.No.	Date	From	Subject	Marked To	Remarks
114	06-09-26	Rohan Paper Suppliers	Order dispatch confirmation	Purchase Dept.	Actioned

Mail Handling — Outward Correspondence

Dak dispatched by the organisation to the outside world

1

Drafting

Letter/memo drafted and typed as per format required.

2

Approval

Signed/approved by the competent authority.

3

Recording

Entered in the Outward Mail Register with serial no.

4

Enveloping

Addressed, sealed; postage/courier label affixed.

5

Dispatch

Sent via post/courier/email and dispatch noted.

Outward Mail Register — Sample Format

S.No.	Date	To	Subject	Mode	Dispatched By
221	06-09-26	Rohan Paper Suppliers	Reminder for pending delivery	Speed Post	A. Sharma

Office Communication Systems

Tools and channels that keep the modern office connected



Email & Groupware

Outlook/Gmail for correspondence, scheduling & file sharing.



Video Conferencing

Zoom, MS Teams, Google Meet for remote meetings.



Intercom / EPABX

Internal telephone exchange linking all departments.



Intranet Portals

Internal websites for circulars, HR forms & notices.



Fax & Printing/Scanning

Legacy fax and MFDs for hard-copy documents.



Instant Messaging

Slack/MS Teams chat for quick internal queries.

Key Takeaways

- A secretary blends interpersonal skill, discipline and IT literacy to run an office smoothly.
- Every document type — letter, notice, agenda, memo, circular, email — has its own fixed format and purpose.
- Reception, telephone handling and appointment scheduling shape the organisation's first impression.
- Inward and outward mail must be systematically recorded for accountability and traceability.
- Digital office-communication systems (email, video-conferencing, intranet) now work alongside — and often replace — traditional paper-based methods.



Thank You

Questions & Discussion — Office Automation & Secretarial Practices | BBA Semester II